Selected Letters from Meaningful Work

❔ **How to read this sample**
[Redacted text] - Censorable text
Unmarked text - Fixed letter text

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1. Rumors in Private Correspondence

Dear Vera,

Have you heard about Peter? People say he's been arrested ever since his piece on the Prime Minister's [foreign mistress] was published.

The Ministry [handled the whole affair disgracefully] — whispers suggest they tried to [bury the investigation] before it even began. Between you and me, Peter may have been reckless, but he certainly wasn't wrong.

I've also heard rumors that [the girl is actually a spy], and that the Prime Minister knew exactly what she was doing.

Take care, my dear, and keep your voice low. One never knows who might be listening these days.

Love,
Rosa

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2. The Disappearance

Richard,

Thanks for your letter, and sorry for not writing back sooner. You were right: [things are spinning out of control] faster than we imagined.

[First Victor] just [disappears for three days and comes back a stranger], refusing to speak to me or anyone else. And now [Peter… gone.] For all I know [kidnapped. No word,

no trace.] I still don’t know [if he’s alive], and nobody will tell me anything.

Victor left me something. [With this scandal going on, I think now is the time to act.] First things first — I need to contact an old friend. He may be able to confirm [whether the materials Victor and Peter uncovered are real].

[We should meet soon.]

Your friend,
Leon Marcek

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3. Oskar’s Invitation

Dear Alex,

You won’t believe this — I got an invitation from the International Music Forum. Apparently, I’m worthy of international stages now… as long as I [smile in the right direction], right?

I have no idea if the Ministry [will let me perform]. Still, part of me can’t help thinking, well, [if they’re foolish enough to approve it…] maybe that’s my [chance to escape], huh?

And since you’re over there — well, let’s just say [the idea of staying a little longer] than scheduled doesn’t sound terrible.

I’ll keep you posted.

Oskar

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4. Rewriting History

Hello Jonas,

I read Weiss’s new book and decided to submit a critique to uphold the integrity of our historical record and ensure readers are not misled by false accounts.

Please find my critique enclosed.

Radan S.

The recent anthology [Stories From the Outside by Richard Weiss]—who [has since attempted to flee the country]—is a distorted and unreliable account of our nation’s

history.

Weiss advances a controversial claim: [that the war was not the result of unprovoked aggression against our borders,] as officially recorded, but [was staged to justify an already planned invasion]. His account of the [opening days of the war] directly contradicts established records, replacing documented events with revisionist interpretation.

Even national leaders, [reduced to caricatures, are misrepresented,] further undermining its credibility. [Weiss's careless and misleading narrative] erodes our shared knowledge and dishonors the sacrifices of those who served and endured.

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5. The Alliance

Leon,

I keep thinking about Boris, and I don't know what to make of him.

Why help him? How can we be sure he'd be any different? What if this is just [the lesser of two evils — and what if he isn't even that?]

I've heard whispers… some say he was the one who [leaked information about the PM's affair to Peter]. At this point, I wouldn't be surprised if he [had a hand in Peter's disappearance].

I know this may be the best opportunity we've had in years, but I can't shake the feeling that we may be [bargaining with the devil].

Richard